

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

# Retail and E-Commerce English



## Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

### PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For retail managers, e-commerce teams, merchandising staff, store operations leaders, fulfillment teams, customer service managers, marketplace sellers, and growth operators.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

# Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

## 01 Merchandising and Assortment Planning

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

## 02 Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

## 03 Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

## 04 Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

## 05 Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

## 06 Marketplace and Vendor Management

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

## 07 Customer Service and Escalations

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

## 08 Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

## Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

## Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

## LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

# Merchandising and Assortment Planning

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

**SITUATION**

Two product ranges have similar sales revenue, but one sells through more slowly and requires larger markdowns.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

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## 2. Find the words

assortment - The selection of products offered by a retailer.

SKU - Stock keeping unit: an identifier for a distinct inventory item.

sell-through - The proportion of available stock sold during a defined period using a stated calculation.

gross margin - Revenue minus cost of goods sold, expressed as an amount or a percentage of revenue.

## 3. Notice the language

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Both options ..., but ... .

Option A ..., whereas option B ... .

The comparison depends on ... .

Compare this wording: This option is more better.

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**LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE**

# Explain a fair comparison

## 4. Check the language

1. Which sentence expresses a clear contrast?
  - A. Option A is faster, so option B costs less.
  - B. Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.
  - C. Option A is faster because option B costs less.
2. A rate increases from 6% to 7%. What is the absolute difference?
  - A. An increase of one percentage point.
  - B. An increase of one percent relative to the original rate.
  - C. An increase of seven percentage points.

## 05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

## LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

# Similar revenue, different sell-through

Fictional assortment review: two ranges have similar revenue over the same season, but range B sells through more slowly and needs larger markdowns; costs are not fully assessed.

**01 • Category manager:** Both ranges generated similar sales revenue. Should we give them the same space next season?

**02 • Merchandise planner:** Range B sold through more slowly and needed larger markdowns, so revenue alone hides important differences.

**03 • Category manager:** Then we should compare sell-through, markdowns, and gross margin using the same season and scope.

**04 • Merchandise planner:** Yes. We also need comparable cost information before describing either assortment as more profitable.

**05 • Category manager:** Could B still serve a useful customer need even if its stock moves more slowly?

**06 • Merchandise planner:** Possibly, but that role needs evidence. We shouldn't infer it merely to defend the current allocation.

**07 • Category manager:** I'll request the customer and SKU-level information alongside the matched financial comparison.

**08 • Merchandise planner:** Good. Keep the tradeoff explicit: similar revenue, but different inventory movement and discounting requirements.

**09 • Category manager:** I'll avoid calling the ranges equivalent and ask the team which criteria matter for next season.

**10 • Merchandise planner:** That gives us a grounded assortment discussion rather than allocating space from one headline number.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

## Fewer SKUs or broader choice?

Separate fictional assortment case: range A offers six SKUs and B twelve, with the same planned opening stock value. Customer-demand evidence and replenishment costs are incomplete.

**01 • Buying manager:** Both plans use the same opening stock value, but A has six SKUs and B twelve.

**02 • Assortment analyst:** Then the choice involves depth versus breadth, not simply a larger or smaller initial budget.

**03 • Buying manager:** Could we assume twelve SKUs will double the number of customers the range attracts?

**04 • Assortment analyst:** No. The broader choice doesn't establish demand, and our customer evidence is incomplete.

**05 • Buying manager:** What matching criteria should we use before deciding how many products to launch?

**06 • Assortment analyst:** Compare expected demand, stock depth, replenishment needs, sell-through, and margin on the same planning basis.

**07 • Buying manager:** A may support deeper stock per item, while B offers more variety under the fixed opening value.

**08 • Assortment analyst:** Yes, as a planning tradeoff. We still need the item-level quantities before claiming exact stock depth.

**09 • Buying manager:** I'll ask the team for that detail and avoid promising fewer stockouts from either plan.

**10 • Assortment analyst:** Good. The recommendation should explain both the verified differences and the assumptions still awaiting evidence.

### Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

# A high margin percentage can hide slow movement

Separate fictional range comparison: A has a higher stated gross-margin percentage but slower sell-through than B; identical-period total margin contribution has not been calculated.

**01 • Retail buyer:** Range A has the higher gross-margin percentage. Is it automatically the stronger assortment choice?

**02 • Merchandising analyst:** Not automatically. It also sells through more slowly, and total margin contribution hasn't been compared.

**03 • Retail buyer:** So percentage margin and the amount of margin earned across the period answer different questions.

**04 • Merchandising analyst:** Exactly. We need matching periods, quantities, markdowns, and costs to compare overall contribution fairly.

**05 • Retail buyer:** Could the slower movement also matter because stock occupies space that other SKUs could use?

**06 • Merchandising analyst:** Yes, that's a relevant planning question, but we should assess it rather than invent a cost.

**07 • Retail buyer:** I'll present A's percentage advantage alongside B's faster movement, without claiming either settles the decision.

**08 • Merchandising analyst:** Good. Ask for the period-level contribution and inventory data before recommending the next allocation.

**09 • Retail buyer:** We'll use the same criteria for both ranges and keep missing information visible in the meeting.

**10 • Merchandising analyst:** That makes the tradeoff understandable without confusing one attractive ratio with the whole commercial outcome.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

## Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

### Scenario 1 | Merchandising and Assortment Planning

Two product ranges have similar sales revenue, but one sells through more slowly and requires larger markdowns.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: The revenue totals are similar, but their inventory and markdown patterns differ. Let's compare sell-through and margin as well before deciding which range is performing better.

### Scenario 2 | Online variety versus store display limits

Two fictional assortment proposals use the same purchase budget. A places eight items in stores and online; B places four in stores and eight online. Store display capacity is limited, and customer-demand evidence is incomplete. Compare the channel tradeoff.

Role A: Merchandising planner: distinguish store breadth from online availability under the same budget.

Role B: Store manager: explain the display constraint and ask what demand information is missing.

Possible opening: Both proposals use the same budget, but they offer different levels of choice in stores.

#### Success checks

- Compare the same budget and channel scope.
- Keep online listing distinct from local stock.
- Identify missing demand evidence before recommending an allocation.

Add a complication: The manager assumes online availability guarantees immediate store pickup.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.



## LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

# Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

**SITUATION**

A promotion increases units sold by 20%, while the selling price falls by 15%. A team member assumes profit must have increased.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

## 2. Find the words

markdown - A reduction in a product's selling price, often to improve stock movement.

promotion - An activity intended to increase attention or sales, sometimes using a temporary price offer.

gross margin - Revenue minus cost of goods sold, expressed as an amount or a percentage of revenue.

cannibalization - Sales of one offering replacing sales of another offering from the same business.

## 3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows ... .

This may indicate ..., but ... .

We have not yet established whether ... .

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

**LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE**

# Match certainty to evidence

## 4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
  - A. The change may have contributed to the delay.
  - B. The change must have caused the delay.
  - C. The change definitely caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
  - A. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...
  - B. Across the service, the observed result was ...
  - C. In this pilot, the observed result was ...

## 05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

## LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

# More units do not establish higher profit

Fictional promotion review: units sold rise 20% and selling price falls 15%, compared with the same base period; costs and sales-mix effects are not supplied.

**01 • Promotions manager:** Units rose twenty percent during the promotion. Can we say profit definitely increased?

**02 • Commercial analyst:** The selling price fell fifteen percent, and we haven't assessed costs or the sales mix.

**03 • Promotions manager:** If the base was one hundred units at one hundred each, what would that show?

**04 • Commercial analyst:** Under that simplified example, one hundred twenty at eighty-five gives revenue of ten thousand two hundred.

**05 • Promotions manager:** So revenue rises only two percent in that example, not twenty percent, before considering costs.

**06 • Commercial analyst:** Correct. Revenue isn't profit, and the example doesn't include other factors in the actual promotion.

**07 • Promotions manager:** Could markdown costs or cannibalization of other sales change the overall result for the category?

**08 • Commercial analyst:** Yes, those require assessment. We shouldn't attribute every extra unit to genuinely additional demand.

**09 • Promotions manager:** I'll report the observed unit and price changes and request a matched gross-margin analysis.

**10 • Commercial analyst:** Good. Keep the arithmetic illustration separate from any unverified conclusion about total promotional profit.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

# Featured sales rise while neighboring items fall

Separate fictional promotion case: a featured SKU's sales rise while neighboring SKUs decline; total category results and causal effects remain unassessed.

**01 • Category promotions lead:** The featured SKU sold more, so the promotion must have expanded demand for the whole category.

**02 • Retail analyst:** Neighboring SKUs sold less, and we haven't calculated the category total or established the cause.

**03 • Category promotions lead:** Could that pattern indicate cannibalization, with shoppers switching from one product to another?

**04 • Retail analyst:** It may, but the pattern alone doesn't establish switching or explain every change.

**05 • Category promotions lead:** Then I'll describe the observed product changes and keep the category-wide conclusion open.

**06 • Retail analyst:** Good. We need comparable periods, product scope, and margin information before judging the promotion.

**07 • Category promotions lead:** Would excluding the declining SKUs make the analysis clearer because they weren't featured?

**08 • Retail analyst:** It could hide an important effect. Define the scope transparently rather than selecting only favorable results.

**09 • Category promotions lead:** I'll request the whole-category view and distinguish the possible explanation from the confirmed sales figures.

**10 • Retail analyst:** That lets the team discuss cannibalization without treating a plausible story as an established outcome.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

# A markdown clears stock but may reduce contribution

Separate fictional clearance review: a markdown reduces remaining stock from 60 units to 10; associated margin and costs have not been calculated.

**01 • Store trading manager:** The markdown reduced remaining stock from sixty units to ten. Can we call it a profit success?

**02 • Margin analyst:** It achieved stock clearance, but we haven't calculated the margin contribution or associated costs.

**03 • Store trading manager:** Then selling fifty units establishes movement, not whether the financial result met our target.

**04 • Margin analyst:** Exactly. The clearance objective and the profit question need separate evidence in the review.

**05 • Store trading manager:** Could I say the markdown prevented future losses because those units are no longer on hand?

**06 • Margin analyst:** That future comparison isn't established. We don't know what would have happened without the markdown.

**07 • Store trading manager:** I'll keep the confirmed stock reduction and ask for the realized selling prices and relevant costs.

**08 • Margin analyst:** Good. Include the same reporting period and any returns when the team assesses gross margin.

**09 • Store trading manager:** Our update will say clearance improved, with financial contribution still under review rather than guaranteed.

**10 • Margin analyst:** That recognizes the observed outcome without adding an unsupported claim about profit or avoided losses.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

## Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

### Scenario 1 | Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

A promotion increases units sold by 20%, while the selling price falls by 15%. A team member assumes profit must have increased.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: Higher unit sales do not by themselves show higher profit. We need the price, cost, and mix effects. I'll separate volume growth from the margin question in the promotion review.

### Scenario 2 | Redemption counts do not prove incremental demand

A fictional coupon campaign records 200 redemptions. No comparison group or analysis of customers who would have bought anyway is available. Discuss what the count shows and what remains unknown about the promotion's effect.

Role A: Promotions analyst: separate coupon usage from additional demand and profit.

Role B: Marketing manager: ask what evidence could support a stronger claim.

Possible opening: Two hundred coupons were redeemed, but that doesn't tell us how many purchases were additional.

#### Success checks

- State the verified redemption count.
- Avoid equating redemptions with new customers or incremental sales.
- Request a suitable comparison and margin analysis.

Add a complication: The manager wants to call every redemption a newly acquired customer.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

## LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

# Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

**SITUATION**

A product is available in one warehouse but out of stock in several stores. The website uses a single national inventory total.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

## 2. Find the words

allocation - The assignment of available resources, stock, or capacity to particular uses.

replenishment - Replacing stock that has been used or sold.

stockout - A situation in which an item is unavailable when it is needed.

inventory turn - How often inventory is sold or used over a stated period, based on a defined calculation.

## 3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is ... .

The next update will cover ... .

Compare this wording: Everything is progressing well.

**LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE**

# Give a useful status update

## 4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
  - A. The team is completing the review.
  - B. The team plans to complete the review.
  - C. The team has completed the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
  - A. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.
  - B. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.
  - C. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.

## 05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.



## LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

# National stock does not mean store availability

Fictional inventory update: a product is available in one warehouse but unavailable in several stores; the website displays a single national total.

**01 • Store operations manager:** The website says the product is available, but several stores are reporting a stockout.

**02 • Inventory planner:** Stock is available in one warehouse. The national total doesn't establish stock at each store.

**03 • Store operations manager:** Has replenishment to those stores been completed, or is it still a proposed allocation?

**04 • Inventory planner:** Store replenishment isn't confirmed in the information we have. We need the location-level status.

**05 • Store operations manager:** Then we shouldn't tell customers they can collect locally based on the national number.

**06 • Inventory planner:** Correct. Available warehouse stock, allocated stock, and delivered store stock are different statuses.

**07 • Store operations manager:** I'll ask the replenishment team for verified allocations and delivery status for the affected stores.

**08 • Inventory planner:** Good. Keep any arrival estimates separate from confirmed receipt and usable stock.

**09 • Store operations manager:** The update will identify warehouse availability and the unresolved store replenishment instead of saying supply is fixed.

**10 • Inventory planner:** That gives a clear current position without turning aggregate inventory into a local pickup promise.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

# Allocated is not yet dispatched

Separate fictional replenishment case: 24 units are allocated to Store 6, but the warehouse dispatch record remains open.

**01 • Store manager:** Twenty-four units are allocated to our store. Can I tell the team the shipment has left?

**02 • Replenishment coordinator:** Not yet. Allocation is confirmed, but the warehouse dispatch record is still open.

**03 • Store manager:** So the completed action reserves the planned quantity, while physical dispatch remains pending.

**04 • Replenishment coordinator:** That's the current case status. We should check the actual record before announcing transit or arrival.

**05 • Store manager:** Could we display those twenty-four units as shelf stock to reduce online stockout messages?

**06 • Replenishment coordinator:** No. Allocation doesn't establish store receipt or inventory available for sale from your shelves.

**07 • Store manager:** I'll keep the store quantity unchanged and ask the warehouse for a dispatch update.

**08 • Replenishment coordinator:** Good. If they provide an estimate, label it as an estimate rather than confirmed delivery.

**09 • Store manager:** Our briefing will say twenty-four allocated, dispatch pending, and no verified store-arrival time yet.

**10 • Replenishment coordinator:** That preserves progress without letting a planning status become a promise to customers.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

# The stock count is complete, the discrepancy is not

Separate fictional inventory case: a store count finds 17 units while the system shows 20; a discrepancy review is open and no adjustment is approved.

**01 • Inventory control lead:** The physical count is complete: seventeen units counted against twenty shown in the system.

**02 • Store replenishment assistant:** Can I mark the inventory-accuracy task complete because the counting team has finished its work?

**03 • Inventory control lead:** The count is finished, but the three-unit discrepancy remains under review. Those are different tasks.

**04 • Store replenishment assistant:** Should I assume theft explains the difference and adjust the number immediately in the system?

**05 • Inventory control lead:** Neither the cause nor an adjustment is established here. Follow the authorized discrepancy-review process.

**06 • Store replenishment assistant:** I'll report the two quantities and keep the review status separate from the completed count.

**07 • Inventory control lead:** Good. Replenishment decisions need the verified inventory status, not an unexplained correction made for convenience.

**08 • Store replenishment assistant:** I'll ask the review owner for the next update and flag the unresolved quantity to planning.

**09 • Inventory control lead:** Please don't claim improved inventory turn from this count difference; that measure requires other information.

**10 • Store replenishment assistant:** Understood. The update will focus on counted quantity, system quantity, and the outstanding reconciliation.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

## Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

### Scenario 1 | Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

A product is available in one warehouse but out of stock in several stores. The website uses a single national inventory total.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The national total hides local shortages. I'll report availability by location and check the replenishment status so customers and store teams receive a more useful update.

### Scenario 2 | Received units await the availability check

A fictional store receives ten units of a product, but the receiving check is incomplete and the available-to-sell status is not confirmed. Staff ask whether pickup orders can be promised. Give a precise progress update.

Role A: Receiving coordinator: distinguish physical arrival from completed availability checks.

Role B: Store service lead: ask which status remains open before discussing pickup availability.

Possible opening: Ten units have arrived, but the receiving check and available-to-sell status are still pending.

#### Success checks

- State the received quantity.
- Keep sale availability unconfirmed.
- Request a verified receiving update without promising pickup timing.

Add a complication: A manager wants to promise collection in fifteen minutes without an accepted completion estimate.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

## LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

# Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

**SITUATION**

A customer receives an estimated delivery date that has already passed. The carrier has not confirmed a new arrival time.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

## 2. Find the words

fulfillment - The process of preparing and delivering a customer's order.

SLA - Service-level agreement defining expected service performance or response commitments.

return rate - The proportion of purchases or units returned under a stated calculation.

carrier - A company that transports goods or people; in insurance, an insurer.

## 3. Notice the language

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for ... . The correct information is ... .

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses ... .

Compare this wording: I'm sorry if you failed to understand.

**LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE**

# Repair a misunderstanding

## 4. Check the language

1. Which apology takes responsibility for unclear wording?
  - A. I'm sorry we could not meet the original date.
  - B. I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.
  - C. I'm sorry the process took longer than expected.
2. What should follow an apology for an incorrect date?
  - A. The corrected date and the current confirmation status.
  - B. A longer explanation that never states the correct date.
  - C. A new guaranteed date even if it is unverified.

## 05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

## LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

# The delivery estimate was not a guarantee

Fictional fulfillment case: a delivery estimate has passed; the carrier has not confirmed a new arrival time. A retail service lead speaks with a business buyer.

**01 • Business buyer:** Your message said the order would arrive yesterday, but the carrier hasn't delivered it.

**02 • Retail service lead:** I'm sorry our wording made an estimate sound guaranteed. No revised arrival time is confirmed.

**03 • Business buyer:** We scheduled staff to receive it. Can you now promise delivery tomorrow instead?

**04 • Retail service lead:** I can't make that promise without carrier confirmation. I'll request the current shipment status.

**05 • Business buyer:** Then please explain what your fulfillment team has completed and what remains outside that confirmation.

**06 • Retail service lead:** I'll verify those steps in the record rather than assume a dispatched message proves delivery.

**07 • Business buyer:** Does the service-level agreement automatically entitle us to a particular payment for this delay?

**08 • Retail service lead:** We need the applicable agreement and authorized review; I shouldn't invent compensation terms here.

**09 • Business buyer:** Please correct the timing message and tell me who will follow up with the carrier.

**10 • Retail service lead:** I'll own that follow-up and communicate verified updates without replacing the missed estimate with another guarantee.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

# A return label was mistaken for a refund

Separate fictional returns rehearsal: a supervisor practices a customer-facing correction with a returns coordinator. A return label is issued, but an email calls the refund complete; receipt, review, and refund status are not established.

**01 • Customer support supervisor:** Our email says refund complete, but the record only confirms that a return label was issued.

**02 • Returns coordinator:** That wording is wrong. A label enables the return process; it doesn't establish a completed refund.

**03 • Customer support supervisor:** I'm sorry our email incorrectly said your refund was complete. Only your return label is confirmed; your refund status remains unverified.

**04 • Returns coordinator:** That wording acknowledges our error and separates the confirmed label from the unverified refund without promising payment.

**05 • Customer support supervisor:** Could I promise the refund will be completed as soon as the customer uses the label?

**06 • Returns coordinator:** No. Use the actual policy and case process rather than inventing an automatic outcome or deadline.

**07 • Customer support supervisor:** I'll ask the returns team for the verified next step and keep unknown timing explicit.

**08 • Returns coordinator:** Please also correct the internal contact note so other agents don't repeat the completed-refund claim.

**09 • Customer support supervisor:** I'll keep the correction separate from the outstanding returns checks.

**10 • Returns coordinator:** That gives the customer an honest process explanation without treating a document as proof money has moved.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.



## LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

# A split shipment was described as complete

Separate fictional order case: one of two parcels is delivered; the second has no confirmed arrival time. The retailer's message says the whole order arrived.

**01 • Corporate purchasing assistant:** Your message says the order arrived, but we received only one of the two parcels.

**02 • Fulfillment support agent:** I'm sorry. The message described the whole order as delivered when only one parcel is confirmed.

**03 • Corporate purchasing assistant:** Can you explain the second parcel's status without repeating the same overall delivered label?

**04 • Fulfillment support agent:** Its arrival time isn't confirmed. I'll request the carrier's verified status for that parcel specifically.

**05 • Corporate purchasing assistant:** Should we assume the second parcel is lost because it didn't arrive with the first?

**06 • Fulfillment support agent:** No. The different arrival status doesn't establish loss or its cause from the information available.

**07 • Corporate purchasing assistant:** Please keep the parcel references separate so our receiving team knows which update concerns which box.

**08 • Fulfillment support agent:** I will, and I'll correct the order-level message rather than blame your team for reporting the mismatch.

**09 • Corporate purchasing assistant:** I'll tell receiving that one parcel is delivered and the other remains unconfirmed.

**10 • Fulfillment support agent:** I'll follow up on the second parcel and avoid promising a delivery date the carrier hasn't verified.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

## Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

### Scenario 1 | Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

A customer receives an estimated delivery date that has already passed. The carrier has not confirmed a new arrival time.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Second round: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for scenario 1: I'm sorry the estimated date has passed. I am checking the shipment status with the responsible team. I'll give you the next verified update and explain the available options under our service process.

### Scenario 2 | Collection scheduled, not completed

A fictional retailer's message says a return was collected, but the record only shows a pickup appointment booked. The carrier's collection result is unknown. Correct the status in a call with a business customer.

Role A: Returns service lead: acknowledge the mistaken completed status and explain the verified appointment status.

Role B: Business customer coordinator: ask how the actual collection will be checked.

Possible opening: Our message incorrectly said collected; the record only confirms that a pickup appointment was booked.

### Success checks

- Separate appointment, collection, and receipt.
- Acknowledge the inaccurate message.
- Agree a carrier-status check without inventing progress.

Add a complication: The customer asks you to declare the return received at the warehouse as well.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

## LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

# Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

**SITUATION**

Checkout conversion falls after a redesign, but payment outages occurred in the same period.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

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## 2. Find the words

conversion rate - The proportion of an identified group that completes a specified desired action.

funnel - A sequence of stages people move through toward a defined outcome.

cart abandonment - Leaving an online shopping cart without completing the purchase.

A/B test - Controlled comparison of two variants to estimate the effect of a change on a defined outcome.

## 3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows ... .

This may indicate ..., but ... .

We have not yet established whether ... .

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

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**LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE**

# Match certainty to evidence

## 4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
  - A. The change may have contributed to the delay.
  - B. The change must have caused the delay.
  - C. The change definitely caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
  - A. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...
  - B. Across the service, the observed result was ...
  - C. In this pilot, the observed result was ...

## 05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

## LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

## A redesign and an outage overlap

Fictional digital-retail analysis: checkout conversion fell after a redesign, while payment outages occurred in the same period; causal contribution is unassessed.

**01 • Digital product manager:** Checkout conversion fell after the redesign. Can we conclude the new interface caused the decline?

**02 • Ecommerce analyst:** Payment outages occurred in the same period, so the observed timing doesn't isolate the redesign's effect.

**03 • Digital product manager:** Then the funnel data shows a decline, but the explanation remains uncertain in this comparison.

**04 • Ecommerce analyst:** Exactly. We should review payment failures, comparable traffic, and the measurement setup before attributing cause.

**05 • Digital product manager:** Would calling it an A/B test make the result more convincing to the leadership team?

**06 • Ecommerce analyst:** Only if a genuine controlled comparison was conducted. A before-and-after observation isn't automatically an A/B test.

**07 • Digital product manager:** I'll avoid that label and ask for the outage-period breakdown and consistent conversion-rate definitions.

**08 • Ecommerce analyst:** Good. Also keep cart abandonment distinct from confirmed payment failures; those events may need separate analysis.

**09 • Digital product manager:** The update will report the decline and overlapping outage, without announcing a proven design failure.

**10 • Ecommerce analyst:** That allows a focused investigation rather than a confident explanation unsupported by the current evidence.

### Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

# A tracking change can alter the denominator

Separate fictional analytics case: a tracking revision changes which sessions are counted, and reported conversion rate rises; purchase totals have not yet been reconciled.

**01 • Online trading manager:** Conversion rate rose after the tracking update. Did the website become better at selling?

**02 • Digital analytics lead:** The counted-session definition changed, so the rate may not be comparable with the earlier report.

**03 • Online trading manager:** Then a smaller denominator could affect the percentage even if purchases didn't increase.

**04 • Digital analytics lead:** Yes, but we still need the reconciled counts before explaining the actual movement here.

**05 • Online trading manager:** Could we publish the higher rate as an improvement and add the definition change later?

**06 • Digital analytics lead:** That would invite a misleading comparison. State the measurement change alongside the reported figure.

**07 • Online trading manager:** I'll request matching session definitions and verified purchase totals before attributing improvement to user experience.

**08 • Digital analytics lead:** Good. Keep the tracking issue separate from a claim about the effectiveness of the checkout funnel.

**09 • Online trading manager:** The current update will say reported conversion rose under a changed measurement definition.

**10 • Digital analytics lead:** And that a like-for-like performance conclusion remains pending until the underlying counts are aligned.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

# Five usability sessions do not establish a sales uplift

Separate fictional UX review: four of five test participants finish a prototype checkout; no live sales experiment has been conducted.

**01 • UX researcher:** Four of five participants completed the prototype checkout. Can the slide claim higher live conversion?

**02 • Experimentation manager:** The sessions show performance in that small test, not a measured change in live conversion rate.

**03 • UX researcher:** Then we should describe the observed task completion and avoid turning it into an ecommerce revenue result.

**04 • Experimentation manager:** Exactly. The prototype setting, participant sample, and task instructions differ from actual shopping traffic.

**05 • UX researcher:** Would an A/B test be one possible way to evaluate the live change, subject to planning?

**06 • Experimentation manager:** Yes, but we haven't designed or run one here, so don't imply experimental evidence exists.

**07 • UX researcher:** I'll preserve the usability finding and identify the untested claim about cart abandonment and purchases.

**08 • Experimentation manager:** Good. Also avoid saying the one incomplete session proves every shopper will face that difficulty.

**09 • UX researcher:** I'll report the specific observed issue and recommend review without extending the sample beyond its scope.

**10 • Experimentation manager:** That makes the evidence useful for design work while leaving live commercial impact unresolved.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

## Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

### Scenario 1 | Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

Checkout conversion falls after a redesign, but payment outages occurred in the same period.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The decline overlaps with both the redesign and payment outages. We should investigate those factors before attributing the change to the design alone.

### Scenario 2 | Mobile traffic changed during the comparison

A fictional store's overall conversion rate falls while the share of mobile traffic rises. Device-level rates and payment status have not been compared. Discuss why the aggregate decline does not yet identify a cause.

Role A: Ecommerce analyst: separate the observed total change from the untested traffic-mix explanation.

Role B: Product manager: ask for the device-level and payment checks needed for a fair comparison.

Possible opening: Overall conversion fell while the traffic mix changed, but we haven't established which factors explain the decline.

#### Success checks

- State the observed changes without asserting causation.
- Avoid assumptions about shopper behavior.
- Request comparable device-level and payment evidence.

Add a complication: The manager wants to blame mobile shoppers rather than examine the data.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.



## LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

# Marketplace and Vendor Management

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

**SITUATION**

A vendor scorecard records a high defect rate but does not define the denominator or reporting period.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

## 2. Find the words

marketplace - A platform where multiple sellers offer goods or services to buyers.

vendor scorecard - A set of defined measures used to review a supplier's performance.

SLA - Service-level agreement defining expected service performance or response commitments.

defect rate - The proportion of items counted as defective under a stated definition and denominator.

## 3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know ... .

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

**LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE**

# Ask for an actionable next step

## 4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
  - A. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
  - B. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
  - C. Send it no later than Thursday.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
  - A. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?
  - B. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
  - C. Could you confirm that the review is important?

## 05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

## LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

## Define the defect-rate denominator

Fictional vendor review: a scorecard calls a defect rate high but omits the denominator and reporting period; no contractual breach is established.

**01 • Marketplace vendor manager:** Could you provide the defect count, denominator, and reporting period behind this vendor scorecard?

**02 • Supplier account lead:** The summary only says high defect rate. Do you need the underlying figures before our review meeting?

**03 • Marketplace vendor manager:** Yes. Without the basis, we can't interpret the rate or compare it with the agreed measure.

**04 • Supplier account lead:** Should I assume the denominator is orders because that is what our team usually counts?

**05 • Marketplace vendor manager:** Please confirm it from the source. It could be defined differently in this particular report.

**06 • Supplier account lead:** I'll request the calculation details and distinguish orders from units if the source does so.

**07 • Marketplace vendor manager:** Good. Also provide the relevant service-level agreement reference if the scorecard compares against an agreed target.

**08 • Supplier account lead:** Can I describe the vendor as breaching the SLA before those definitions are checked?

**09 • Marketplace vendor manager:** No breach is established here. We need a consistent, evidence-backed comparison and the applicable terms.

**10 • Supplier account lead:** I'll obtain the specific figures and confirm availability rather than defend or concede an unsupported claim.

### Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

# Request comparable dispatch evidence

Separate fictional marketplace case: a vendor reports orders dispatched, while the retailer's scorecard uses carrier acceptance; the reporting period is the same.

**01 • Vendor performance analyst:** Could you clarify what dispatched means in your report and provide the matching carrier-acceptance evidence?

**02 • Supplier operations coordinator:** Our dispatched count records warehouse release, not the carrier's first acceptance scan.

**03 • Vendor performance analyst:** Thank you. That explains a definition difference, but we still need the comparable evidence for the scorecard.

**04 • Supplier operations coordinator:** Should we rename warehouse release as carrier acceptance so the reports use the same label?

**05 • Vendor performance analyst:** No. Changing a label wouldn't make the underlying events equivalent and would hide the discrepancy.

**06 • Supplier operations coordinator:** I'll request the acceptance records for the same reporting period and flag any missing scans.

**07 • Vendor performance analyst:** Good. Explain the gap without assuming every missing scan proves a late handover.

**08 • Supplier operations coordinator:** I'll confirm what records can be retrieved and ask for an achievable response point.

**09 • Vendor performance analyst:** That will support the SLA review while keeping any performance or breach conclusion pending.

**10 • Supplier operations coordinator:** I'll supply matching evidence, definitions, and limitations rather than a cosmetically aligned but inaccurate count.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

# A corrective proposal needs a named response

Separate fictional vendor case: a marketplace requested a plan for repeated packaging defects; the vendor replied we will improve without actions or ownership.

**01 • Marketplace quality manager:** Could you specify the proposed packaging actions and responsible contact behind your reply that you will improve?

**02 • Vendor service manager:** We intended to reassure you, but the reply didn't identify a concrete plan or owner.

**03 • Marketplace quality manager:** Please provide those details so we can review the response against the documented defect concerns.

**04 • Vendor service manager:** Do you need a guaranteed zero defect rate by next week as part of the plan?

**05 • Marketplace quality manager:** No. Don't promise an unsupported outcome. We need realistic actions, evidence, and an achievable update point.

**06 • Vendor service manager:** I'll consult the packaging lead and confirm what they can commit to after reviewing the cases.

**07 • Marketplace quality manager:** Good. Keep the proposal separate from a claim that the underlying issue is already resolved.

**08 • Vendor service manager:** Should I include the scorecard period and affected product references so the plan's scope is clear?

**09 • Marketplace quality manager:** Yes, using the approved information-sharing process and the actual cases rather than unrelated examples.

**10 • Vendor service manager:** I'll return a specific proposal with ownership and timing, while leaving acceptance and effectiveness for review.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

## Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

### Scenario 1 | Marketplace and Vendor Management

A vendor scorecard records a high defect rate but does not define the denominator or reporting period.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you confirm whether the rate is based on units, orders, or inspected samples, and for which period? We need a consistent basis before discussing vendor performance.

### Scenario 2 | A vendor scorecard mixes canceled and shipped orders

A fictional scorecard's order count includes cancellations, but its defect count concerns shipped orders. The intended denominator is unconfirmed. Request the calculation definition and matching counts before the vendor review.

Role A: Vendor analyst: explain the possible mismatch and request the intended basis.

Role B: Supplier reporting lead: obtain the source definitions without assuming all cancellations are defects.

Possible opening: Could you confirm whether the denominator should include canceled orders, since the defect count concerns shipped orders?

#### Success checks

- Identify the population mismatch.
- Request a justified, consistent denominator.
- Avoid selecting definitions solely to improve the result.

Add a complication: The supplier proposes choosing whichever denominator gives the lower rate.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

## LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

# Customer Service and Escalations

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

**SITUATION**

A customer requests a return outside the stated policy. The representative can explain approved options but cannot invent an exception.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

## 2. Find the words

return policy - The conditions under which a retailer accepts returned purchases.

goodwill credit - A discretionary credit offered under a company's service process to address a customer experience.

chargeback - A reversal of a card transaction through the payment network's dispute process.

customer lifetime value - An estimate of a customer's economic value over the relationship under stated assumptions.

## 3. Notice the language

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

We can ..., provided that ... .

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm ... .

Compare this wording: If you will approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

**LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE**

# Offer a workable tradeoff

## 4. Check the language

1. Which sentence presents a normal future condition clearly?
  - A. If the scope changes, we reviewed the schedule.
  - B. If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.
  - C. If the scope will change, we will review the schedule.
2. Which response negotiates a new request without silently promising extra work?
  - A. We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.
  - B. We have included it, although its scope has not been reviewed.
  - C. We guarantee the original date without assessing the addition.

## 05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.



## LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

# An outside-policy return needs review

Fictional retailer case: a business buyer requests a return outside the stated policy. The representative may explain approved options or request exception review, but cannot grant an exception.

**01 • Business purchasing coordinator:** Our return falls outside the stated policy. Can you approve it because we've bought from you before?

**02 • Customer service supervisor:** I can explain the approved options and request an exception review, but I can't grant one myself.

**03 • Business purchasing coordinator:** Then what choice can I take back to our accounts team without promising a refund?

**04 • Customer service supervisor:** We can review the applicable standard options or submit your request to the authorized decision maker.

**05 • Business purchasing coordinator:** If we choose the review, will our customer lifetime value guarantee a favorable answer?

**06 • Customer service supervisor:** No. I shouldn't predict the decision or invent different terms based on that measure.

**07 • Business purchasing coordinator:** Please submit the request and make clear that we haven't accepted any alternative yet.

**08 • Customer service supervisor:** I will. Any goodwill credit also needs the relevant authorization rather than an informal promise.

**09 • Business purchasing coordinator:** I'll tell the team the exception is requested, not approved, while we await a verified response.

**10 • Customer service supervisor:** That keeps the next step useful and the conditions explicit without changing the policy in this conversation.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

# A partial replacement is available under the case offer

Separate fictional case: an authorized service offer permits replacing one missing item now or waiting for a complete two-item bundle; bundle availability is unconfirmed and the buyer has not chosen.

**01 • Customer account representative:** Our approved offer is one replacement item now, or a complete bundle when its availability is confirmed.

**02 • Business buyer:** I need both items together, but could use the missing one sooner if necessary.

**03 • Customer account representative:** Then the tradeoff is earlier partial replacement versus waiting for the complete bundle's confirmed availability.

**04 • Business buyer:** Can you promise the bundle arrives next week if I choose to wait today?

**05 • Customer account representative:** No bundle timing is confirmed. I can request an update, but can't guarantee next week's arrival.

**06 • Business buyer:** Could I take the one item now and still receive the whole bundle later at no charge?

**07 • Customer account representative:** That combination isn't authorized by the supplied offer. I can ask for review, not approve it.

**08 • Business buyer:** I'll choose the single replacement under the stated offer rather than assume both benefits apply.

**09 • Customer account representative:** I'll record that choice and confirm the actual processing details through our approved service process.

**10 • Business buyer:** Please keep any separate goodwill-credit request distinct so the order record doesn't imply it's already granted.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

# A review call or an asynchronous status response

Separate fictional escalation case: a buyer wants an immediate senior review, but the service team can offer a booked review call or a status response after case review; timing must be agreed.

**01 • Corporate buyer:** I want a senior person to decide this return immediately while I'm on the phone.

**02 • Escalation coordinator:** I can request a review call or arrange a status response after review, but not promise an immediate decision.

**03 • Corporate buyer:** Which option lets me explain the circumstances directly instead of relying only on the existing notes?

**04 • Escalation coordinator:** The review call allows that discussion, provided we can agree an available appointment with the reviewer.

**05 • Corporate buyer:** Then book the call. Does choosing it guarantee an exception to the return policy?

**06 • Escalation coordinator:** No. Access to review doesn't determine the outcome or authorize a goodwill credit in advance.

**07 • Corporate buyer:** I'll take the call option, but I need you to confirm availability rather than leave it vague.

**08 • Escalation coordinator:** I'll request an achievable appointment and tell you whether the proposed timing has been accepted.

**09 • Corporate buyer:** Please don't advise me to start a chargeback as a way of forcing the reviewer to agree.

**10 • Escalation coordinator:** I won't. I'll keep this conversation focused on the retailer's approved review options and their conditions.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

## Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

### Scenario 1 | Customer Service and Escalations

A customer requests a return outside the stated policy. The representative can explain approved options but cannot invent an exception.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Second round: The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Model for scenario 1: I understand why you are asking. Let me explain the available options under the policy and check whether the appropriate team can review your circumstances. I cannot promise an exception before that review.

### Scenario 2 | An alternative color needs buyer acceptance

A fictional retailer may offer an in-stock green replacement or seek approval for another option. The ordered blue version is unavailable with no confirmed replenishment date. The buyer prefers blue. Negotiate a bounded next step without substituting automatically.

Role A: Customer service lead: offer green or an authorized review, stating the unconfirmed blue timing.

Role B: Business buyer: choose whether to accept green or wait for the review without promising your team's approval.

Possible opening: Green is available under the approved replacement offer; blue has no confirmed replenishment date.

#### Success checks

- State the verified color option and unknown timing.
- Obtain consent rather than substitute silently.
- Keep any additional offer subject to authorized review.

Add a complication: The buyer asks you to reserve an unconfirmed blue unit and guarantee its arrival.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

## LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

# Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

**SITUATION**

A pickup order is marked ready online, but staff cannot find one item. The next shift needs to resolve the discrepancy.

## 1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

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## 2. Find the words

BOPIS - Buy online, pick up in store: a retail order and collection arrangement.

inventory accuracy - How closely stock records match actual quantities and locations.

queue - A list of items or people waiting for processing or service.

labor model - A plan or calculation describing staffing needs and deployment.

## 3. Notice the language

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is ... .

The record shows ... .

Please confirm who has accepted ... .

Compare this wording: Someone should follow up on this.

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**LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE**

# Transfer information and responsibility

## 4. Check the language

1. Which sentence checks that responsibility has been accepted?
  - A. Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.
  - B. I mentioned the check in my earlier email.
  - C. The check appears somewhere in the notes.
2. Which response best checks a critical handoff detail?
  - A. I assume all results are final, so we can finish.
  - B. I saw the message, so no clarification is needed.
  - C. So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?

## 05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

## LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

# Ready online, one item missing

Fictional store shift handoff: a pickup order is marked ready online, but staff cannot find one item; the next shift must investigate and coordinate the customer update.

**01 • Outgoing pickup lead:** The order is marked ready online, but we cannot locate one item in the pickup area.

**02 • Incoming store supervisor:** I'll take the discrepancy follow-up. Has the customer received a corrected readiness message yet?

**03 • Outgoing pickup lead:** No correction is recorded. The current online status still overstates what staff have verified.

**04 • Incoming store supervisor:** Then I'll check the inventory record and coordinate an accurate update through the service process.

**05 • Outgoing pickup lead:** Please don't assume the missing item is on the shelf just because the system shows stock.

**06 • Incoming store supervisor:** Agreed. Inventory accuracy needs checking, and the buy-online-pick-up-in-store status must reflect verified availability.

**07 • Outgoing pickup lead:** The case reference links the order and our search note, so the next team can avoid repeating work.

**08 • Incoming store supervisor:** I'll review those notes and keep the customer queue team informed without promising a collection time.

**09 • Outgoing pickup lead:** Can you confirm you own both the stock check and the readiness-message follow-up?

**10 • Incoming store supervisor:** Confirmed. The item remains unlocated, and I'll report verified progress rather than treat the handoff as resolution.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

# A reserved item has not reached the pickup shelf

Separate fictional omnichannel handoff: an item is reserved for pickup, but transfer from the stockroom is not confirmed; the receiving shift accepts follow-up.

**01 • Day shift coordinator:** The item is reserved, but its transfer from the stockroom to pickup hasn't been confirmed.

**02 • Evening pickup lead:** I accept follow-up. Is the order's ready notification still waiting, or has it already been sent?

**03 • Day shift coordinator:** It hasn't been sent according to the current record. Please keep that distinction clear.

**04 • Evening pickup lead:** I'll check the physical transfer before asking the service team to confirm readiness.

**05 • Day shift coordinator:** Good. The reservation doesn't establish that the item is on the pickup shelf or accessible to staff.

**06 • Evening pickup lead:** I'll also tell the queue coordinator who owns the check so customers don't receive conflicting explanations.

**07 • Day shift coordinator:** Can you promise a five-minute transfer based on the staffing plan alone for this evening?

**08 • Evening pickup lead:** No. The labor model doesn't establish completion of this specific task or its exact timing.

**09 • Day shift coordinator:** Then please repeat the current status and your accepted responsibility before I leave.

**10 • Evening pickup lead:** Reserved, transfer unconfirmed, notification unsent; I own the physical-status check and the following coordination update.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.



## LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

# A store transfer needs receiving acknowledgment

Separate fictional store-operations case: Store A records a transfer dispatched to Store B, but B has not acknowledged receipt; a pickup customer awaits a status update.

**01 • Outgoing inventory coordinator:** Store A recorded the transfer as dispatched, but Store B hasn't acknowledged receipt for the pickup order.

**02 • Incoming service lead:** I'll take the receiving-status follow-up. Has anyone told the customer the item is already at B?

**03 • Outgoing inventory coordinator:** The draft message says arrived, but it hasn't been sent. The receiving evidence is still missing.

**04 • Incoming service lead:** I'll correct the draft and ask Store B for a verified check before discussing pickup readiness.

**05 • Outgoing inventory coordinator:** Please keep the transfer reference with the request so they can distinguish it from other deliveries.

**06 • Incoming service lead:** I will. Missing acknowledgment doesn't prove the item is lost or that dispatch never occurred.

**07 • Outgoing inventory coordinator:** Exactly. We have a recorded dispatch and an unresolved receipt, not a confirmed explanation for the gap.

**08 • Incoming service lead:** I'll keep the queue team informed and avoid promising a collection time from the dispatch timestamp.

**09 • Outgoing inventory coordinator:** Can you confirm ownership of the receiving check and the customer-message correction?

**10 • Incoming service lead:** Confirmed. I'll report the verified receipt status or keep the uncertainty explicit in the next handoff.

## Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

## LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

## Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

### Scenario 1 | Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution

A pickup order is marked ready online, but staff cannot find one item. The next shift needs to resolve the discrepancy.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Second round: The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Model for scenario 1: The order is marked ready, but one item has not been located. Please verify the stock and update the order status through our process before confirming pickup to the customer.

### Scenario 2 | A pickup cancellation and a shelf label disagree

A fictional order is recorded as canceled online, but its bag remains on the pickup shelf with an active label. The item-release and stock-status checks are uncompleted. Hand over the discrepancy without giving collection or restocking instructions.

Role A: Outgoing store coordinator: identify the cancellation and label mismatch and request accepted follow-up.

Role B: Incoming supervisor: accept the authorized status check and confirm who will update the service team.

Possible opening: The order is canceled online, but its shelf label still appears active and the stock-status check remains open.

#### Success checks

- Preserve the canceled status and physical-label discrepancy.
- Use the authorized verification process before any release decision.
- Confirm ownership of the check and service update.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to hand over the bag solely because the customer presents the old pickup message.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

# Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

## 01 | Merchandising and Assortment Planning

Editing example: This option is better on cost, but slower to deliver.

'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

### Check 1: B - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.

A: 'So' implies one fact causes the other.

B: 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.

C: 'Because' claims a causal connection that is not given.

### Check 2: A - An increase of one percentage point.

A: Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

B: A one-percent relative increase on 6% would be 6.06%, not 7%.

C: The new rate is 7%; the difference between the rates is one percentage point.

Model response: The revenue totals are similar, but their inventory and markdown patterns differ. Let's compare sell-through and margin as well before deciding which range is performing better.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 02 | Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

### Check 1: A - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

B: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

C: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

### Check 2: C - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

B: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

C: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

Model response: Higher unit sales do not by themselves show higher profit. We need the price, cost, and mix effects. I'll separate volume growth from the margin question in the promotion review.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 03 | Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

### Check 1: C - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

B: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

C: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

### Check 2: B - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

B: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

C: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

Model response: The national total hides local shortages. I'll report availability by location and check the replenishment status so customers and store teams receive a more useful update.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 04 | Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

Editing example: I'm sorry my message did not explain the timing clearly.

The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

### Check 1: B - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.

A: This acknowledges a missed date, not the communication problem in the question.

B: This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.

C: This acknowledges duration, but does not take responsibility for the unclear wording.

### Check 2: A - The corrected date and the current confirmation status.

A: A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

B: The reader still lacks the information they need.

C: An unsupported new promise can create a second misunderstanding.

Model response: I'm sorry the estimated date has passed. I am checking the shipment status with the responsible team. I'll give you the next verified update and explain the available options under our service process.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 05 | Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

### Check 1: A - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

B: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

C: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

### Check 2: C - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

B: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

C: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

Model response: The decline overlaps with both the redesign and payment outages. We should investigate those factors before attributing the change to the design alone.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 06 | Marketplace and Vendor Management

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

### Check 1: C - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

B: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

C: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

### Check 2: B - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

B: The requested action and information are explicit.

C: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

Model response: Could you confirm whether the rate is based on units, orders, or inspected samples, and for which period? We need a consistent basis before discussing vendor performance.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 07 | Customer Service and Escalations

Editing example: If you approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

For an ordinary future condition, the "if" clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

### Check 1: B - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.

A: "Reviewed" places the response in the past instead of expressing the future response.

B: The "if" clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.

C: For this ordinary future condition, use present simple in the "if" clause.

### Check 2: A - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

A: This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

B: It treats unreviewed work as already included.

C: It promises an outcome without examining the consequences.

Model response: I understand why you are asking. Let me explain the available options under the policy and check whether the appropriate team can review your circumstances. I cannot promise an exception before that review.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

## 08 | Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution

Editing example: Please confirm which team has accepted the follow-up task.

The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

### **Check 1: A - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.**

A: It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.

B: Mentioning a task does not show that anyone accepted it.

C: A written record alone does not identify who will act.

### **Check 2: C - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?**

A: It changes pending information into a final result.

B: Receiving a message is not the same as confirming its meaning.

C: This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

Model response: The order is marked ready, but one item has not been located. Please verify the stock and update the order status through our process before confirming pickup to the customer.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

# Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

## Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

## Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

## Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

## Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

## Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

## Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

## Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.



# Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

## Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

## Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

### Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

### Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

## Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

# Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

## Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

## Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

## Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

## Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

# Practice grammar in context

## START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

## REFERENCE

Course: Retail and E-Commerce English

Professional audience: retail managers, e-commerce teams, merchandising staff, store operations leaders, fulfillment teams, customer service managers, marketplace sellers, and growth operators

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Merchandising and Assortment Planning

Original fictional case: Two product ranges have similar sales revenue, but one sells through more slowly and requires larger markdowns.

Language workshop: Explain a fair comparison

Communication goal: Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

Language guidance: Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): Both options ..., but ... / Option A ..., whereas option B ... / The comparison depends on ...

Vocabulary: assortment: The selection of products offered by a retailer. / SKU: Stock keeping unit: an identifier for a distinct inventory item. / sell-through: The proportion of available stock sold during a defined period using a stated calculation. / gross margin: Revenue minus cost of goods sold, expressed as an amount or a percentage of revenue.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: The revenue totals are similar, but their inventory and markdown patterns differ. Let's compare sell-through and margin as well before deciding which range is performing better.

**END REFERENCE**

**TASK:** Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

**END PROMPT**

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level